

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 584

By Cepicky

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the Columbia Academy girls' cross country team, 2024 TSSAA Division II, Class A state champions.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we honor those Tennessee students who, through their athletic prowess, have achieved the pinnacle of success and serve as exceptional ambassadors of the Volunteer State; and

WHEREAS, one such group of estimable individuals is the Columbia Academy girls' cross country team, which won the 2024 TSSAA Division II, Class A state championship, the first such title in school history; and

WHEREAS, state championships are achieved only through hard work, dedication, and the commitment to working together as a team and excelling with a cooperative spirit; the Columbia Academy Bulldogs exhibited each of these rare qualities during their championship season; and

WHEREAS, the Columbia Academy girls' cross country team won the 2024 state title under the astute leadership of Head Coach Brady Henson and assistant coaches Nathan Miller, Ashley Miller, and David Craig; and

WHEREAS, during the championship competition, held at Sanders Ferry Park in Hendersonville on November 8, 2024, the Bulldogs displayed the tenacity, camaraderie, and skill befitting the state's finest athletic teams; and

WHEREAS, Columbia Academy posted an average time of 20:36:81 to win the state championship with 44 points, besting their closest opponent by 15 points; and

WHEREAS, in the five-kilometer race, Gracie Orton was state runner-up, placing second overall with a time of 19:39.28; Presley Miller placed fourth at 20:09.76; Janie Reames placed

eighth at 20:31.64; Charley Ray Hutchison placed fourteenth at 20:53.52; Emma Rees placed thirty-first at 21:49.86; Keeley Reames placed forty-first at 22:45.93; and Mackenzie Reames placed forty-third at 22:57.79; and

WHEREAS, other contributing and supportive members of the Columbia Academy team were Emma Bookout, Braelyn Henry, Annyston Barker, Ella Buckley, Lakelyn Haley, Ava Buckley, and Jayden Massey; and

WHEREAS, the Columbia Academy Bulldogs' noteworthy achievement is a tremendous source of pride for their families, their classmates, and their entire community; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the members of the girls' cross country team of Columbia Academy for serving as exemplars of the high quality of the youth of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the members and coaches of the Columbia Academy girls' cross country team on winning the 2024 TSSAA Division II, Class A state championship and extend to them our best wishes for continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.